Use of ICT	Candidates may use a word processor to produce their report, although they will not gain any extra marks for doing so. In order to ensure that candidates demonstrate their understanding of the principles and techniques involved in analysing data, the use of ICT, eg spreadsheets, may not be used for analysing data for this unit.
Draft work	Candidates should do a variety of practical work during the course so that they develop the necessary skills to succeed in this unit. They should not, therefore, submit draft work for checking. However, teachers should check candidates' plans for health and safety issues before they implement the plan. Neither the plan nor any practical work submitted for this unit should be returned to candidates for them to improve it.
How science works	This unit will cover the following aspects of how science works as listed in *Appendix 6: How science works* 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, and 9.

6.2 Assessment information

Introduction

Candidates must produce a written plan for an experiment. They must also produce a laboratory report for an experiment that they have carried out. The experiment that they carry out may be based on the plan that they have produced; alternatively, the experiment that they carry out may be based on a plan that is either centre-devised or Edexcel-devised.

Plan

Students should not be given advanced details of the plan that they will carry out; they will be expected to draw on their experience of practical work that they have completed during the course for this assessment. Students should not take into the classroom any materials for this assessment.

If more than one group of students take this assessment at different times, then the groups must submit different plans for assessment to prevent plagiarism.

Centre-devised plans and experiments will not required Edexcel's approval; however, centre devised assessments must ensure that students have the opportunity to gain all the marks in the mark scheme.

If teachers are going to mark the plan they should not provide students with feedback on their plan until they have carried out their experiment and analysed their results. At this stage teachers could either:

i) photocopy the plan, mark the original plan and provide students with the photocopy in the laboratory so that they can carry out their plan

ii) collect in the plan, not mark it and return it to students in the laboratory under supervised conditions so that they can carry out their plan

iii) mark the plan and ask students to do an experiment based on a different plan.

If teachers are not going to mark the plan, they should collect the plan and check its feasibility. At this stage the teacher could either:

i) return it to students in the laboratory under supervised conditions so they can carry out their plan

ii) ask students to do an experiment based on a different plan.